

MScAC Initiative Budget Proposal

Event: Machine Learning Trivia Night with Dinner

Date: Friday, December 19, 2025, 6:00 PM to 9:00 PM

Venue: MScAC Room 9016

Estimated Attendance: 30

Purpose

This initiative serves two primary objectives: to foster stronger **social cohesion and bonding** among the cohort during the winter period, and to provide a fun, engaging way to promote **recruiting preparation** by refreshing students' knowledge of core Machine Learning concepts ahead of the winter/spring recruiting cycle. The collaborative trivia format will encourage informal, low-stakes knowledge sharing.



[Source](#)

Event Components

- **Dinner (6:30 PM - 7:15 PM):** A catered dinner will be served buffet/family-style to facilitate casual networking and allow students to arrive and settle in comfortably before the main activity.
- **Trivia Competition (7:15 PM - 8:15 PM):** Students will pre-register/self-select into teams of 4–5 to compete in a multi-round ML trivia competition. Questions will cover a range of ML/CS fundamentals, recent advancements, and applied concepts relevant to internship interviews.
- **Prize Ceremony and Social Hour (8:15 PM - 9:00 PM):** A brief prize-giving ceremony will recognize the top two teams. The room will remain booked until 9:00 PM to allow attendees to finish food, play supplementary board games, and continue socializing.

RSVP Plan

RSVP collection, including confirmation of attendance and any specific dietary restrictions (e.g., allergies, religious requirements), will be managed through a dedicated Google Form or Discord channel. The catering order will be finalized based on the confirmed attendance 48 hours prior to the event date to minimize waste and ensure adequate quantity.

Next Steps

- **Finalize Venue Booking**
- **Develop Trivia Content:** Create three to four rounds of engaging Machine Learning trivia questions.
- **Source and Procure Prizes:** Purchase the U of T Bookstore merchandise or gift cards for the winning teams.
- **Submit Documentation:** Submit all receipts, the final invitation list, and the attendee sign-in sheet for full budget reimbursement. (ESSENTIAL)

Total Budget Requested: \$1000

Component	Description	Estimated Cost	Quantity/Notes
Catering - Dinner	From one of sourced vendors	\$700	30 pax
Trivia Prizes	U of T Bookstore Merchandise (e.g., hoodies, mugs, gift cards) for the top two teams (4-5 members each).	\$150	To incentivize participation and reward performance.
Logistics/Supplies	Disposable plates/cutlery, napkins, trash bags, game materials (printouts, pens).	\$50	Essential supplies and clean-up.
Beverages	Purchased Separately from Walmart/Dollarama for Cost Savings	\$50	30 pax
Total		\$960	